

## Blazing a trail with Gear & Cheer

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Many 5K walks and benefit events take place at Bradys Run Park, but the one on Sept. 8 will be different.

Bands will rock and bikes will roll, and there will be plenty of beer.

The Gear & Cheer Music Festival will feature eight bands, along with outdoorsy activities such as road cycling, a mountain bike race, paddleboarding, canoeing, kayaking, rock-wall climbing and a 5K walk and run.

The music starts at 8:30 a.m. with the gospel-bluegrass sounds of Olive Mountain Band.

Then comes Pittsburgh country singer Justin Fabus; Beaver alt-rock acts the AnnaJames Band and the East Enders; New Brighton rockers Communication Breakdown and their pop-rock-soul neighbors the Brighton Boys; Youngstown country-rockers High Noon; and a Christian-rock band from Pittsburgh, Circle of One.

Tickets to just see the concert are \$5 for youths 13 to 17 (12 and younger are free); and \$10 for adults.

To also take part in the road cycling, mountain biking, kayaking, paddleboarding and other outdoor activities -- not to mention beer tastings that include local homebrewers -- tickets run from \$20 to \$35.

Gear & Cheer benefits the Ohio River Trail, a proposed walking-bicycling path through Beaver County that ultimately could link the Montour Trail near Coraopolis with a similar trail in Columbiana County, Ohio.

The Ohio River Trail is the brainchild of Dr. Vincent Troia, a Monaca optometrist who saw the light one day when he couldn't decide if he should go biking on the Montour Trail, or the Little Beaver Creek Greenway Trail in Lisbon, Ohio.

"They're about the same distance away, and I thought, why don't we just connect the trails?" Troia said. "That would be fantastic."

Since 2007, he assembled the nonprofit Ohio River Trail Council that has obtained \$35,000 in grants, erected signs and conducted two feasibility studies. Much work

lies ahead, such as obtaining property easements from utility companies. Some parts of the trail would share commonly traveled streets, other sections would be fresh paths over vacant property, including old trolley lines.

The Ohio River Trail Council envisions a day when Beaver County is a "Pedal-Paddle" destination, where people ride bikes down a trail, then return along the same path via kayak.

Trails are popular in these eco-friendly times.

With a few gaps left to fill, the Montour Trail ultimately will connect with the 150-mile Great Allegheny Passage, which already links with an 184-mile Maryland trail that reaches Washington, D.C.

The upshot: One day, you'll be able to ride a bike from Coraopolis to Washington, D.C., without having to tangle with cars.

Ohio is working on a similar trail stretching from Cleveland through Columbiana County to the Beaver County line.

Beaver County could be the trail link between Cleveland and Washington, D.C.

"It's possible," Troia said.

If nothing else, it's an excuse for the Sept. 8 Gear & Cheer Music Festival, a more hip and diverse event than what's normally offered in Bradys Run Park.

Maybe for that one weekend, at least, it'll shut up those Twitter users at #beavercounty who whine about there being nothing to do here.

## BUCKCHERRY AT CONNEAUT

Buckcherry performs next Sunday at Conneaut Lake Park.

The L.A. hard-rock band, with Riverside High grad Keith Nelson on lead guitar, will play outdoors near the site of an Aug. 1 fire that destroyed the Beach Club at the 121-year-old amusement park in Crawford County.

Buckcherry will charge fans \$50 for backstage meet-and-greet passes, with 100 percent of the proceeds going to the Rebuild the Beach Club campaign (more details at [hotelconneaut.com](http://hotelconneaut.com)).

I can tell you Buckcherry's backstage was jam-packed on May 4, right after the group's Stage AE show in Pittsburgh. There was a refrigerator filled with beer, and it didn't take much coaxing for fans -- many of them Nelson's Beaver County pals -- to partake.

The Conneaut Lake show is for a 21-and-older crowd, with tickets costing \$18 in advance, and \$23 the day of the show.

Buckcherry has been on the road much of this summer, supporting a new album "Confessions," which has sold more than 50,000 copies.

Two nights prior to the Conneaut show, Buckcherry will perform at the massive Harley-Davidson 110th anniversary festival in Milwaukee. They go on at 9 p.m., the same time as the four other stages' other headliners -- The Gaslight Anthem, Sublime with Rome, Common and Dierks Bentley.

#### MISSING PERSON NEARBY

Terry Bozzio will appear Sept. 8 in nearby Columbiana, Ohio, helping to raise money for a faith-based social charity.

Bozzio, the drummer for Frank Zappa's Mothers of Invention from 1975 to 1978 and co-founder of New Wave band Missing Persons ("Walking in L.A."), will greet fans at an open house at the Universal Percussion drum center.

Admission is \$10 plus two cans of food, which will be donated to The Way Station, a nonprofit group that helps Columbiana County residents affected by addiction, poverty and abuse.

The following night, Bozzio will perform at Jergel's Rhythm Grille in Marshall Township.

Esquire magazine saved the No. 9 spot for Bozzio in its "Top-10 Craziest Drummers" list. The magazine dug his massive kit that includes three dozen drums, two dozen cymbals, and assorted gongs and tambourines.

Esquire chose Ginger Baker of Cream as the craziest drummer for his on- and off-stage antics.

#### FASHION FORWARD

Jeremy "Danger Frog" Mulder has launched his own clothing line.

The 3-7 p.m. weekday deejay for Beaver County's Froggy-FM unveiled his Danger Wear line with a limited edition, distressed crew-neck T-shirt. It has his "Danger Show" logo in Froggy green and gold.

Take a look at [pittsburghtee.com](http://pittsburghtee.com)

Wonder how Mulder's sales will stack up against Wiz Khalifa, who on Friday debuted his own line of Converse Chuck Taylor All-Star sneakers.

Available at Foot Locker and Footaction stores, Khalifa's kicks sell for \$60 to \$85, and come in 12 styles, "inspired by the artist's rebellious and fashion-forward style."

#### TIDBITS

A new biography on Pittsburgh jazz giant Billy Eckstine arrives Sept. 24.

"Mr. B: The Music and Life of Billy Eckstine" (\$18.99) spans the vocalist and bandleader's career from the Depression to the 1990s, chronicling how he became America's first black romantic singing idol.

Author Cary Ginell relied on newspaper clippings, trade magazines, record albums and insights from Eckstine's children to explain how the native of Pittsburgh's Highland Park area sold millions of records and influenced artists ranging from Johnny Mathis to Barry White to Elvis Presley.

Donnie Iris and the Cruisers will head back to the studio in a few weeks to work on some new songs.

"We have five or six rhythm tracks done," Iris said. "Not sure if it will be a full album or an EP. All of us are more than anxious to get back to work."

(Scott Tady is entertainment editor for The Times, and enjoys getting emails at [stady@timesonline.com](mailto:stady@timesonline.com))